

DO NOT USE

Dangerous Abbreviations, Symbols, and Dose Designations

Institute for Safe Medication Practices Canada

For a more detailed version, see: ismpcanada.ca/do-not-use-list

DO NOT USE	ALWAYS USE
Abbreviated medication name (e.g., MSO4, MTX)	Use full name of medication
U	Use units
IU	Use International units
ug, µg	Use microgram or mcg
cc	Use millilitre or mL
OD, QD	Use daily
QOD, EOD	Use every other day
D, d	Use days or doses
x/7, y/52	Use x days, y weeks
AS, AD, AU	Use left ear, right ear, both ears
OS, OD, OU	Use left eye, right eye, both eyes
< >	Use less than, lower than or more than, greater than
@	Use at
D/C medication A, medication B	Use discharge when referring to a discharge with medications from a care area. <i>Where discontinue is intended, stop or discontinue may be safer alternatives.</i>
I, II, III, IV, ... ī, īī, īīī, ...	Use the intended Arabic numerals , or spell out the numeral .
X.0 (trailing zero)	Use X <i>Never use zeroes after a decimal point.</i>
.X (lack of leading zero)	Use 0.X <i>Always use a zero before a decimal point.</i>